

MERIDIANHEALTH INSURANCE

REF: MH-EXC-2026-047

Claim Exclusion Reference

Services, Treatments, and Conditions Not Covered
Plan Year 2026

Effective: January 1, 2026 | Version: 3.1

Licensed: CT, NY, NJ, PA, MA, MD, VA, NC, GA, FL, OH, IL, MI, TX, CO, AZ, WA, OR, CA, MN, WI, IN

WARNING: Excluded services listed herein are not covered regardless of medical necessity determination, except where specific exceptions are noted in the exclusion entry.

>> SECTION 1 — PURPOSE AND SCOPE

This Claim Exclusion Reference lists services, treatments, supplies, and circumstances not covered under MeridianHealth Insurance plans. Exclusions are categorized as: (A) Permanent Exclusions applying to all plans; (B) Conditional Exclusions applying to specific plan types or circumstances; and (C) Benefit Limitations. Read together with the Plan Benefits Guide (MH-BRO-2026-047) and Terms and Conditions (MH-TC-2026-047). If a service appears in both the Benefits Guide and this Exclusion Reference, the exclusion governs.

>> SECTION 2 — PERMANENT EXCLUSIONS (ALL PLANS)

[EXC-2.1]

Cosmetic Surgery and Procedures. Surgery or procedures performed primarily to improve appearance rather than restore function or treat a medical condition. Includes rhinoplasty for cosmetic purposes, blepharoplasty when not affecting vision, liposuction, abdominoplasty, breast augmentation for cosmetic purposes, hair transplantation, dermabrasion, and chemical peels. EXCEPTION: Reconstructive surgery following a covered accident, injury, or mastectomy is covered under all ACA plans per the Women's Health and Cancer Rights Act. Reconstructive surgery for congenital anomalies in dependents under 19 is also covered.

[EXC-2.2]

Experimental or Investigational Treatments. Any treatment, procedure, drug, biological product, or device not approved by the U.S. FDA for the specific indication being treated, or that is the subject of an ongoing Phase I/II/III clinical trial, or not recognized as safe and effective by peer-reviewed medical literature. EXCEPTION: Routine patient care costs associated with participation in a qualifying clinical trial are covered under ACA plans per ACA Section 2709.

[EXC-2.3]

Services Not Medically Necessary. Services that MeridianHealth's Medical Director determines are not medically necessary as defined in the Terms and Conditions (MH-TC-2026-047, Section 1). Includes convenience services, services more costly than equally effective alternatives, and elective procedures not addressing a diagnosed condition.

[EXC-2.4]

Non-Emergency Services Outside the United States. Health care received outside the U.S., its territories, and possessions, except emergency services required to stabilize an emergency medical condition while temporarily traveling abroad. Emergency services abroad are reimbursed at the in-network rate up to the MAA.

[EXC-2.5]

Workers' Compensation and Occupational Injury. Injuries or illnesses arising out of and in the course of employment covered under workers' compensation. If a claim is denied by workers' comp, MeridianHealth will review under standard plan terms with written documentation of the denial.

[EXC-2.6]

Services Covered by Government Programs. Services payable under Medicare, Medicaid, TRICARE, or VA, except as required for coordination of benefits under applicable law.

[EXC-2.7]

Self-Inflicted Injuries. Injuries intentionally self-inflicted or from attempted self-harm. EXCEPTION: Injuries resulting from a diagnosed mental health condition (depression, bipolar disorder, schizophrenia, etc.) are covered per the Mental Health Parity Act.

[EXC-2.8]

War and Terrorism. Injuries or illnesses from declared or undeclared war, armed conflict, terrorism, or nuclear/biological/chemical events.

>> SECTION 3 — CONDITIONAL EXCLUSIONS

The following exclusions apply only under the conditions specified. Where an exclusion applies to certain plan types only, the applicable plan type is identified.

[EXC-3.1]

Infertility Treatment. IVF, IUI, GIFT, ZIFT, donor procurement, and surrogacy costs excluded under Bronze and Silver plans. Gold and Platinum plans cover up to 3 IVF cycles per lifetime with \$30,000 lifetime max. Prior authorization required. Diagnostic testing covered under all tiers. State mandates may require additional coverage.

[EXC-3.2]

Bariatric Surgery. Excluded under Bronze. Silver, Gold, Platinum cover when: BMI ≥ 40 or BMI ≥ 35 with comorbidity; 6+ months documented non-surgical weight management failure; Bariatric Center of Excellence; prior auth obtained. Supplemental Shield: excluded entirely.

[EXC-3.3]

Dental Services (Adult). Routine dental for members 19+ excluded under medical plan. EXCEPTIONS: dental from accidental injury to natural teeth (treatment within 72 hours); dental integral to a covered medical procedure. Pediatric dental for under-19 covered as EHB.

[EXC-3.4]

Vision Services (Adult). Routine vision exams, glasses, contacts for 19+ excluded. EXCEPTION: medical treatment of eye diseases (glaucoma, cataracts, macular degeneration, diabetic retinopathy) covered. LASIK excluded. Pediatric vision for under-19 covered as EHB.

[EXC-3.5]

Alternative Therapies. Acupuncture, naturopathy, homeopathy, Ayurvedic, Reiki excluded under Bronze, Silver, and Supplemental Shield. Gold and Platinum cover acupuncture for chronic pain: 20 sessions/year, PA after 12th. Chiropractic covered all ACA plans: 20 visits/year.

[EXC-3.6]

Hearing Aids. Excluded under Bronze. Silver/Gold/Platinum: 1 per ear every 36 months, max \$2,500/ear. Supplemental Shield: excluded. Cochlear implants covered as surgical benefit under all ACA plans.

[EXC-3.7]

Skilled Nursing Facility. Covered up to 60 days/year under all ACA plans following 3+ day inpatient stay for same condition. Custodial care (ADL assistance) excluded under all plans.

[EXC-3.8]

DME Limitations. Covered at coinsurance rate, PA for items $> \$1,000$. Rental preferred over purchase for < 13 months. Least costly medically appropriate alternative. Convenience/luxury items and athletic equipment excluded.

>> SECTION 4 — BENEFIT LIMITATIONS

Service	Limitation	Applies To
PT / OT / Speech Therapy	30 combined visits/year; PA beyond	All ACA plans
Chiropractic Care	20 visits/year	All ACA plans
Acupuncture	20 sessions/year (PA after 12th)	Gold, Platinum only
Skilled Nursing Facility	60 days/year	All ACA plans
Home Health Care	120 visits/year	All ACA plans
Inpatient Rehab (substance use)	2 admissions/year, 30 days each	All ACA plans
Residential Treatment (MH)	60 days/year; PA after 14 days	All ACA plans
Infertility (IVF)	3 cycles lifetime; \$30K lifetime max	Gold, Platinum only
Hearing Aids	1/ear per 36 months; \$2,500 max/ear	Silver, Gold, Platinum
Pediatric Orthodontia	Medically necessary; \$2K lifetime max	All ACA plans
Hospital Indemnity (Supp.)	30 days/confinement; \$250/day	Supplemental Shield
ICU Indemnity (Supp.)	15 days/confinement; \$500/day	Supplemental Shield

PA = Prior Authorization. Visit/day limits reset January 1. Lifetime limits do not reset.

>> SECTION 5 — PRE-EXISTING CONDITION EXCLUSION (SUPPLEMENTAL SHIELD)

The Supplemental Shield plan excludes claims related to pre-existing conditions during the first 12 months from the policy effective date. A pre-existing condition is any condition for which medical advice, diagnosis, care, or treatment was recommended or received during the 12-month look-back period preceding the effective date. After 12 months, pre-existing conditions are eligible on the same basis as any other condition. This exclusion does NOT apply to ACA-compliant plans, which cover pre-existing conditions from day one per the ACA.

Commonly identified conditions: diabetes (Type 1 and 2), hypertension, asthma/COPD, coronary artery disease, cancer (active or in remission within 12 months), chronic kidney disease, HIV/AIDS, epilepsy, rheumatoid arthritis, and major depressive disorder. This list is not exhaustive.

>> SECTION 6 — EXCLUSIONS AND APPEALS

If a claim is denied based on an exclusion herein, the member may appeal through the process in the Terms and Conditions (MH-TC-2026-047, Section 7) and Claim Process Guide (MH-CPG-2026-047, Section 5). Medical necessity appeals are reviewed by a physician not involved in the denial. Experimental/investigational denials may be escalated to external review by a specialty-specific IRO.

This Claim Exclusion Reference is part of the policy contract. Exclusions are subject to change at policy renewal with at least 60 days' notice. MeridianHealth Insurance Company | Hartford, CT 06103